Silent as the Grave

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Teen And Up Audiences

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by yagirlStatic

Summary

Adora was really into trying to talk to ghosts before she died. Now Catra has to figure out how to grieve.

-OR-

5 times Catra tries to do a summoning ritual, and 1 she doesn't.

Notes

Just so there's no confusion: the rituals do not bring Adora back to life. They're how Catra is coping with her death.

Had this about 1/3 done for a month or two, then had kind of a crap morning and finished it all today. Hope you... enjoy? Is that what you're supposed to do with MCD fics?

See the end of the work for more notes

1: Denial

Adora can't be dead.

She just… *can't* be.

She's coming over in a few minutes.

She's supposed to be, at least. They agreed on it yesterday. And sure, it's late, but Catra's moms both sleep like rocks, so it's never been hard for Adora to sneak in through the window.

So Catra's just going to. Get a head start on things while she waits. Set up the dumb summoning circle. Again. Light the stupid candles. Again. And maybe this time, whenever Adora actually shows up, they'll finally. she doesn't know . Summon her grandmother or something. She's still not exactly sure how it works. *If* it works, seeing as it hasn't any of the other times, but Adora likes it and Catra likes Adora, so what's the harm?

Her moms come and sit with her at some point. She's not really paying attention to the time.

t' s at least a couple hours until the candles run out of wax to burn, though.

And Adora never shows up.

2: Bargaining

Adora isn't stupid. An idiot, yeah, but she isn't *stupid.* So *obviously* there has to be something to this whole summoning thing. Otherwise Catra's just some jackass that spent an entire day's pay on an Ouija board. More on some novelty black candles. A crystal glass that apparently she's supposed to touch. Some holy water, though on second thought that might be bad for ghosts, so she just shoved it in

the back of a drawer and forgot about it. She even got a sage smudge, whatever that is, for god's sake.

So it doesn't really make sense that when she finally sets everything up, her hesitant call of "Hey , Adora" goes unanswered.

She makes a mental note to grab a protractor next time she's at the store. She couldn't find hers earlier, so that's probably why it didn't work this time. She just messed up the angles, or something.

It'll work next time.

It'll work.

3: Anger

Catra tries a couple more times, but it doesn't work. Of course it doesn't fucking work. So she shoves all the supplies to the back of her closet, and smashes everything she feels into this little ball inside her chest, until she finally gets a night to herself. Her moms out to get dinner, she grabs the lighter.

"I'll be fine, Catra," she says, mockingly . "Sure, I'll be doing twenty over on a rainy night with shitty headlights, but I know where the turns are, there's no way I'd *wrap my fucking car around a tree."*

She wants to hurl something. Maybe something small and breakable, maybe what little remains in her stomach.

Maybe both.

She wants to rip the world apart with her bare hands, and she wants to punch Adora right in her stupid perfect teeth, but she can't *do* that because Adora *fucking died on her.*

Catra throws her hands up, tail lashing. "You know that's not a fucking coping mechanism! Listening to music in your room is a

coping mechanism! And sure, I call you an idiot a lot, but we both know you're not stupid enough to think what basically amounts to *street racing* is a reasonable fucking way to handle your shit, Adora! But nooooo, you just *had* to come see me, and you just *had* to see how fast you could go and *dammit,* Adora!"

She winds up and kicks one of the candles with full force. It snaps in two, shards of wax spraying around her room from the break, the string barely connecting the two halves as they go spinning across the room, the wick quickly snuffed by the air whirling past it.

Catra's foot, on the other hand, continues its arc into the chair by her desk with a sickening crunch.

"Fuck!"

When her moms come up to her room after getting home, intent on giving Catra the extra order of sushi they'd brought back for her, they're greeted with the sight of their daughter, sobbing on the floor, cradling a broken toe.

4: Depression

At some point, Catra throws the Ouija board away. The glass gets misplaced. The fancy black candles burn to nothing, and she doesn't bother replacing them.

It never works. And if she's going to keep doing this just to keep the memory of a girl alive, she might as well do it the way they'd done it at the start: a hastily drawn pentagram on a dry erase board, five shitty white candles in shitty metal holders placed haphazardly at the points.

Even knowing nothing will happen, that nothing *ever* happens, Catra waits. She still waits, the five pinpoint flames slowly burning down in front of her.

She waits, and she waits, and she waits, wax dripping down the candles and tears dripping down her face, until the silence is so thick it's deafening.

"Did you know I loved you?" She suddenly asks, unable to stomach another second in this oppressively quiet room without saying something. "Because *I* didn't. Not really. Not until you were gone, and it was too late, and so much more of me than I thought went missing with you."

"I mean, I kind of knew. I had to have known, at least a little bit. I just… I didn't know what kind of love it was, I guess."

It's not like Catra didn't know what love looked like. Her moms have been sickeningly in love longer than she's been alive. She just… hadn't really thought about it. She was Adora's, Adora was hers, and that's all either of them needed to know.

"You probably realized. At least, some part of you probably did, you were always smarter than anybody gave you credit for. But in case you didn't… I loved you, Adora. Still do, actually. And I don't think I'll ever stop."

"Just thought you should know," she whispers.

The silence comes back. It always does.

Catra sits and watches the candles until they burn out.

5: Acceptance

Catra carefully lights each of the candles in turn, then closes her eyes, leaning back and sitting cross legged on the floor.

"Hey, Adora," she says. "Sorry. I know it's been a while. Smoke detectors in the dorm were kind of twitchy. Scorpia's girlfriend set them off with her bong once, actually."

That had been a disaster. Scorpia panicking about getting expelled, Perfuma just giggling from being high off her mind, and Catra doing the actual legwork of covering it up.

"Kinda sucks you're dead, honestly. I ended up setting a styrofoam plate on fire in the microwave to mask the smell, and that would've been *way* more believable coming from you. I mean, it worked out in the end, but still." She lets out a soft chuckle. She could still smell it at the time~~,~~ even through the god-awful stench of burning styrofoam ~~,~~ but the RA was a human, so they'd managed to get away with it.

Catra cracks an eye open as a slight breeze whirls around the room, causing the candles to flicker slightly as it ruffles her fur. If Catra didn't know better, she'd say it feels almost indignant. It's a pretty drafty house, though.

"You'd probably like her. Sociology major, so some psychoanalyzing going on, and sure, she can be a bit of a preachy vegan at times, and I'm not selling her very well, am I?"

Catra closes her eyes again. "Stop me if I ramble," she says, and then laughs at her own joke. "But yeah, you'd like her. She's nice."

"Classes are going okay. Passed that exam I was worrying about last time. Kinda scraped by honestly, but hey, a pass is a pass. Who knew trying to be a doctor was hard? I mean, everybody that's done it, obviously, but aside from *that."* She laughs at her own joke again.

"Speaking of doctors, found a new one. Changed up my meds some. Been doing better." She's not perfect, of course. Catra's not sure she'll ever be perfect, honestly, but even where she is right now is so far from where she's come, so much further than she thought she'd be able to get. "I hope you're happy for me."

She pauses to think about her wording for a second, tilting her head. "God, that sounds presumptuous, doesn't it. I just~~e~~h, you know what I mean. You always did."

She gives it a few more minutes, but can't think of anything else to tell Adora, and she's got an assignment she's been putting off for probably a little too long.

"See you around,"she whispers with a bittersweet smile, then takes a breath and blows the candles out.

+1

She doesn't try to talk to Catra when she's awake. Not any more, at least;there was only so much of that Adora could take, pouring her heart out to somebody that never even noticed.

So when Catra is awake, Adora listens. And when she's asleep, Adora speaks.

"I miss you,"she says. She'd never really considered a life~~or~~ a death, for that matter~~tha~~t didn't have Catra in it. She might be *there,* tantalizingly close, but she's not *here,* and the most Adora can ever do is try to brush a strand of hair out of her face from time to time.

"I'm proud of you,"she says. She'd do anything to have spared Catra this pain, but she's so in awe of the person Catra has forced herself to be. Sure, she's still Catra. She'll always be snarky, and a little bit of a bitch sometimes, but this Catra is still a Catra that cares. One that didn't close herself off forever, didn't shrink into her shell until she felt no pain but didn't feel anything else, either.

"I'm sorry ,"she says.

She knows Catra probably can't hear her anyways, but it's easier to pretend like this. To pretend that maybe, just maybe, some small part of Adora can get through to her, even if Catra won't remember in the morning.

End Notes

Thanks to qeenmillicentofbystander for being a beta for this on short notice.

I'm on Twitter, if you'd like to complain in a jovial and light-hearted fashion.

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!